

Left Side Living: Navigating Cars, Rentals, and Driving When PCSing to the UK



Getting your transportation sorted is one of the biggest hurdles when moving overseas, but we have broken down everything you need to know to hit the ground running. You can jump directly to the exact information you are looking for by clicking on any of the sections in the table of contents below, where we cover the strict rules for **US vehicle importation**, how to navigate **UK vehicle purchases** for a local car, your best options for **Car rentals**, arranging seamless **Taxis from the Airport** upon arrival, and the essential safety tips you need for **Driving in the UK** on the left side of the road.

US Vehicle Importation

- ☐ Preparing to Import a Vehicle
- ☐ Drop Off/ Pick Up from Vehicle Processing Center (VPC)
- ☐ If Delivery Date is Missed
- ☐ Once Vehicle has Arrived
- ☐ Registering a Vehicle
- ☐ Obtaining License Plates
- ☐ Where You May Drive While Waiting for Registration
- ☐ Paying Road Tax
- ☐ The Must-Have Light Conversions for US Cars
- ☐ IVA / MOT Requirement
- ☐ Car Insurance

Buying a Vehicle in the UK

- ☐ Required Documents Needed
- ☐ Step by Step: Buying Registering a British Vehicle
- ☐ What is a MOT?
- ☐ Where to Buy a Used Vehicle

Taxis and Car Rentals

- ☐ From the Airport to your Temporary Lodging Facility
- ☐ Taxis
- ☐ Car Rentals in the Tribase Area

Driving in the UK

- ☐ How to Get Your Drivers License
- ☐ Driver License Study Guide

Statutory Off-Road Notice (SORN)

*****Valid for 365 days*****

- When going TDY for an extended period you MUST complete a SORN if your road tax will expire
- You may face fines/penalties from DVLA for failure to comply

SCRAPPING A TAX FREE VEHICLE

Sponsor only

- Bring the V5 to Pass/Reg to obtain a Form 5
- Take the vehicle to a registered scrap dealer
- Get the form completed and signed by the scrap dealer
- Bring the Form 5, all DFP's and the yellow portion of the V5 to Pass/Reg

IMPORTANT NOTES

****If you receive more than £99 you will be required to pay tax on the amount****

****Failure to follow these guidelines may cause a payment of 22.5% of vehicles value to HM Customs****

SCRAPPING A TAX PAID VEHICLE

- Bring yellow section of the V5 signed by a scrap dealer
- All DFP's in household

POWER OF ATTORNEY (PoA):

- Pick up formatted Special PoA from Pass/Reg
- Deliver to Legal Office
- You **MUST** use a **SPECIAL** PoA
- The PoA must be submitted to Pass/Reg for clearance thru HM Customs before use

CANNOT LEND YOUR TAX-FREE VEHICLE TO ANYONE

- **ONLY** immediate family members (spouses/ children) are authorized to drive your tax free vehicle

IF YOU ARE UNSURE ABOUT SOMETHING, PLEASE CALL FIRST BEFORE PROCEEDING WITH YOUR TRANSACTION.
A SIMPLE PHONE CALL COULD SAVE YOU A LOT OF TIME AND MONEY!

USEFUL NUMBERS:

RAFL Pass and Registration

DSN: 226-1853
Comm.: 01638-52-1853
Mildenhall TMO: 01638-542202
Brandon Transcar Mildenhall
01638-515714
01638-562752
USAA (London): 0800-289192
Geico: 0800-318524
Hobby Shop RAFL 226-2454

HOURS OF OPERATION

MON 0730-1600
TUES 0730-1600
WED 0730-1600
THURS 0930-1600
FRI 0730-1530



Pass And Registration



Pass & Registration
48th Security Forces Squadron
Building 977
RAF Lakenheath
Brandon
IP279PN
01638-525990



VEHICLE TRANSACTIONS **(SALE OF A TAX FREE VEHICLE)**

(Import)

*****Both the BUYER and SELLER must be present- SPONSOR ONLY*****

SELLER

- V5 British Registration Document
(If you have lost your V5 it will cost you £25 for a replacement)
- MOT or SVA
- Valid Road Tax Disc
- All Driving Fuel Permits (DFP) in household
- If you are selling to an **UNENTITLED** person you **MUST** complete a Form 5 and pay the import taxes

BUYER

*****Authorizations: Single 1 Tax free Vehicle/
Married 2 Tax free Vehicles*****

- Insurance coverage for the vehicle
- All DFP's in household
- If Component Civilian: proof of Componency status (i.e. Passport or letter)

SALE OF A TAX PAID VEHICLE **(i.e. local acquired vehicle)**

SELLER

- Bring the signed portion of the V5
- All DFP's in household

BUYER

- New Keeper Supplement (green portion of V5)
(If you have lost your V5 it will cost you £25 for a replacement)
- MOT or SVA
- Receipt for valid Road Tax Disc
- Insurance coverage for the vehicle
- All DFP's in household

Once you collect your vehicle you must **return to Pass and Registration with the** **following:**

- Insurance Certificate (no insurance card or green cards)
- Original registration or Copy of Title
- Marriage Certificate (If names are different on documents)
- Stamped pink customs form
(the one Brandon will return to you on collection of vehicle)
- Light conversion
- MOT (If vehicle is 3 years or older) **or** SVA (If vehicle is less than 3 years old)
- SVA not required for motorcycles
- Affidavit: If you have a valid reason for exceeding the 30 day registration window, you may include an affidavit to avoid back-paying arrears for road tax. (i.e. Failed MOT, Emergency, TDY)

IMPORTANT NOTES – MUST READ!!!

*****You must complete the vehicle registration within the same calendar month that you collect your vehicle (not 30 days)*****

*****If you exceed the allotted time, you must back-pay road tax for each calendar month it is late, which is currently £19.16*******

*****You are only authorized 30 days to drive on Stateside/foreign plates.*****

*****It is illegal to drive without plates displayed on Vehicle - paper plates are not authorized for use*****

Completed Registration

- Your registration paperwork will be sent to DVLA and will return to our office within 7-10 business days completed.
- You will be contacted via email or telephone to collect your documents from our office .

- Successfully complete driver's training @ BLDG 950/Family Readiness Center (Every Wed @ 0800)
- Collect 3 AF FORM 435, Driving/Fuel Permit within 30 days
- Bring a valid Stateside/USAEUR/UK/Foreign License to BLDG 977/Pass & Registration
- Please do not attempt to collect your DFP earlier than 1000 the next day
- Component Civilians must show proof of Componency status via passport or memo from orderly room or human resources office
- Contractors must show passport (date last entered in the UK is required)

Weapons Registration

- Sponsors must complete a weapons declaration

VEHICLE REGISTRATION **(IMPORTED VEHICLE)**

*****Also called Customs Concession or Tax Free*****

- Single or Married Unaccompanied are authorized **1** Tax Free Vehicle
- Married Accompanied/MIL-MIL/MIL-GS/GS-GS/Component CONT-Component CONT/MIL-Component CONT are authorized **2** tax free Vehicles
- Motorcycles imported in household goods are also considered Tax Free (meaning count toward your allocation)
- To collect your vehicle from the VPC/Port please bring a document containing the VIN and model information
- **ONLY** the **SPONSOR** may sign for C&E 941 Customs Form (the form that releases your vehicle from the port)

OBTAINING 3 AF FM 435/DRIVING **FUEL PERMIT (DFP)**